CELEBRATING 17 YEARS OF IMPACTFUL MILESTONES & EXCELLENCE IN EDUCATION

What started off as a quest to collate and share an educational roadmap for confused youngsters to plan and chart their future has now grown into an institution that takes the responsibility to hand hold them till they reach their destination. Strengthened by likeminded individuals & organizations like HDFC Bank, Oracle, Capgemini, Standard Chartered GBS, HSBC Technology, YES Bank, LTI Mindtree, IndusInd Bank, Concord Biotech, VFS Global, DBS Bank, Wells Fargo, Syngenta, bp and Castrol who have joined hands; It has now grown into a social initiative that is actively changing the future of a generation.



MR. KETAN DESHPANDE,
Founder Chairman & CEO, FUEL Business School

Q1. An initiative to inform students about the various growth options available to them, has now grown into an enabler that reaches out to them and hand holds them in their efforts to join the mainstream. When and why did you first realize the need for widening your scope of involvement?
Ans: After facing confusion in career choices post my 12th standard, I missed crucial exams due to lack of guidance. This led to the inception of FUEL, an institution focused on reducing unemployment and guiding youth. Our Edu Connect program provides skill training aligned with industry needs. I wrote a book on empowering youth, sent it to Dr. Kalam, and he tasked me with training 10 million youth. My burning desire to fulfill this target is aimed at serving the nation.

Q2. From offering hands-on training that will enable rural students with minimal education to gain fruitful employment to courses that need a basic engineering degree FUEL covers the entire gamut. You also have Business Administration programs. There has been a need based natural progression across the years. Would you like to take us through the situations that you encountered, that prompted you to roll these programmes.
Ans: Initially, FUEL began with certification courses in Future skills like JAVA, Python, and Artificial Intelligence. However, realizing the challenges students faced in securing jobs with these certificates, we pivoted to offering formal degrees with industry-aligned curricula. This shift allows students to gain hands-on experience alongside theoretical knowledge, addressing the practical needs of the job market.

Q3. You aim for a 100% penetration at school levels across a district. How many districts have you covered so far? What does your road map for the future look like?
Ans: We have 30+ industry partners who have helped us to cover 16+ states. We are working on the Hub and Spoke model. We are currently started our programme in Indonesia and we are working on spreading our programme in Jakarta, and other South Asian Countries.

Q4. What has been the impact of your initiatives, so far? How have youngsters benefited? What has been the impact of the progress on their families? How has this influenced other youngsters around them?
Ans: With over a million beneficiaries, FUEL has collaborated with engineering colleges and 30+ industry partners to offer skill development programs in areas like Digital Marketing, Core Java, Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Blockchain, and 3D printing. The impact extends to talent search coaching for standard X–XII and scholarship programs. The majority of beneficiaries come from low-income agriculture backgrounds. Through the FUEL Business School (FBS), we empower girls from such backgrounds, not only enhancing their individual prospects but also elevating their family status. This success inspires other girls to overcome socioeconomic barriers and pursue their passions.

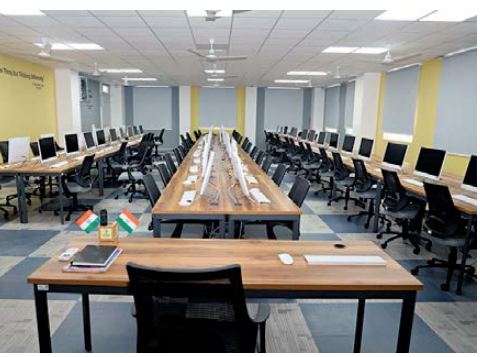
Q5. How have Corporates responded to your initiatives? How have they benefited from it?
Ans: FUEL, initiated with a small investment and a vision to empower youth, has garnered support from 30+ prominent companies such as Capgemini, HDFC Bank, Oracle, Microsoft, Fujitsu, Standard Chartered GBS, Citi Bank, LTI Mindtree, and Lenovo. These companies actively participate in education programs for students from low-income backgrounds, demonstrating a commitment to social responsibility. FUEL ensures a seamless process, allowing companies to invest in education with ease and contribute to societal well-being.

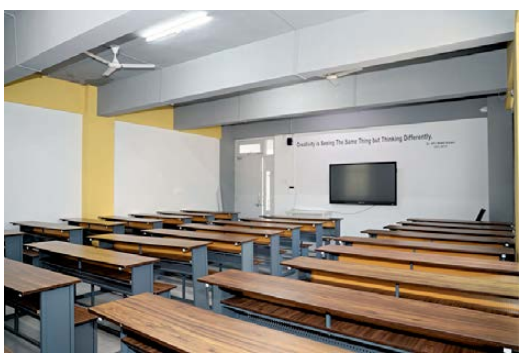
Q6. Who all can associate with you? How can they contribute?
Ans: Anyone can contribute to FUEL be it by providing scholarship for the students, to work with FUEL by being the trainer or by simply being a volunteer.

Q7. What are your future plans? How is FUEL planning to fuel India's growth in the years to come?
Ans: FUEL's future plans involve expanding the impact by introducing formal degree programs, including BBA and PGDM, through FUEL Business School. The focus is on expanding FBS across India and pioneering scholarship-driven programs to empower students to dream big and achieve their aspirations, aiming to become the first institute in South Asia to do so. Going forward FUEL is planning to establish a Skills and Entrepreneurship University funded through social impact (CSR/ HNI) initiatives.



MR. SANTOSH HURALIKOPPI
Chief Mentor, FUEL Business School







World Class Infrastructure at FUEL Business School